

How to generate alternatives

- Humans stick to what they know works
- But considering alternatives is important to 'break out of the box'
- Designers are trained to consider alternatives, software people generally are not
- How do you generate alternatives?
 - 'Flair and creativity': research and synthesis
 - Seek inspiration: look at similar products or look at very different products

How to choose among alternatives

- Evaluation with users or with peers, e.g. prototypes
- Technical feasibility: some not possible
- Quality thresholds: Usability goals lead to usability criteria set early on and check regularly
 - safety: how safe?
 - utility: which functions are superfluous?
 - effectiveness: appropriate support? task coverage, information available
 - efficiency: performance measurements
 - learnability: is the time taken to learn a function acceptable to the users?
 - memorability: can infrequent users remember how to achieve their goal?